

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1237

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Kermit Taze Lofton, Sr.,
of Henderson.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of
the passing of Kermit Taze Lofton, Sr.; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Lofton was a highly respected member of his community and a
consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow
citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born in Adamsville on May 9, 1940, Taze Lofton was the son of Taze Elmo
Lofton and Verda Lee Whitten Lofton; he moved with his family to Millington and attended
Millington High School, where he was a member of the marching band, before moving once
more with his family to Henderson, graduating from Chester County High School in 1958; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Lofton attended Freed-Hardeman College for one year, where he was a
member of the Griffin's Men's Tumbling Team, and transferred to Bethel College in 1961,
graduating in 1964 with a degree in business administration; and

WHEREAS, while attending Bethel College, he met the love of his life, Nancy Karen
Barnerd; the two were wed on July 11, 1964, and made their home in Henderson; and

WHEREAS, after graduating from college, he worked for Casey Funeral Home and at
Goodyear as a credit sales manager, while also farming on the family land; he then went into
business with Anthony Bolton and opened Bolton-Lofton Used Cars; and

WHEREAS, in 1972, Taze Lofton and Anthony Bolton purchased Stroud Chevrolet in
Henderson, renaming the franchise Bolton-Lofton Chevrolet; in 1978, Mr. Lofton became
primary owner of the dealership, and the name was changed to Lofton Chevrolet, Inc.; and

WHEREAS, he retired from the dealership in 2008, leaving the business with his sons and General Manager Ronnie Geary; in 2022, Mr. Lofton and the Lofton Chevrolet Family celebrated 50 years of business, during which time they had been blessed with numerous wonderful loyal employees and customers; and

WHEREAS, after retiring, Mr. Lofton returned to his love for farmland and working outdoors and became interested in heavy equipment; he could often be seen on his backhoe or trackhoe moving dirt and cleaning his farm in Pinson in south Madison County; and

WHEREAS, an avid race car driver, Taze Lofton competed on various dirt tracks in West Tennessee, driving a black B-car sporting the number 62; a crowd favorite, he went two full seasons without a loss in a feature race and held the track record at various speedways, including Riverside Speedway in West Memphis, Arkansas; and

WHEREAS, he had a lifetime love of cars and racing and was a collector of antique cars, especially the 1963-1967 Corvette; he was also a passionate NASCAR fan, traveling to numerous tracks across the country to cheer on his favorite man in black, Dale Earnhardt. He and his wife enjoyed international traveling with the GM cooperation, and RV camping with their fellow NASCAR friend traveling crew; and

WHEREAS, his other avocations included golfing as a member of the Woodland Hills Golf and Country Club, boating, and spending time with his family at his home at Pine Lake; and

WHEREAS, Taze Lofton served his community as a member of Henderson Church of Christ, as well as a volunteer at Freed-Hardeman University and a member of the University's Development Council and President's Council; he was honored to receive the University's Volunteer of the Year Award for 2006-2007; and

WHEREAS, Taze Lofton was also deeply devoted to his family and always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, he will be sadly missed but fondly remembered by his wife of sixty-one years, Nancy; sons, Kermit (Debbie) Lofton and Spence (Julia) Lofton; grandchildren, Drew Lofton, Alex Lofton, Spencer Lofton, and Paige Lofton; and sister, Nona Lofton (Dwain) Seaton; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, Mr. Lofton was preceded in death by his brothers, Larry Lofton and Leon Lofton, as well as a nephew, Leon Lofton, Jr.; and

WHEREAS, Taze Lofton leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Kermit Taze Lofton, Sr., reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Lofton.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.